

Downloading R and RStudio:

R – you must do this first

1. Download R from the CRAN website: <https://cran.r-project.org/>
2. Choose the download link for your operating system (Windows or macOS).
3. Download the latest release of R. As of August 2026, the current version is R 4.6.1.
4. Run the installer and follow the installation instructions.

***** Do this step to update R even if you already have it. We should all be using the most up-to-date version of R.**

RStudio – install this second

1. R must be installed first. Open R once to make sure that it is launched correctly, then close it.
2. Download RStudio Desktop here: <https://posit.co/download/rstudio-desktop/>
3. Download the free RStudio Desktop installer for your operating system (Windows or macOS).
4. Run the installer and follow the installation instructions.
5. Open RStudio.

***** If you already have RStudio, update it so everyone in the class is using the same version. As of August 2026, use RStudio 2026.08.1 (Yellow Yarrow).**